User Guide: C3 Electoral Register Initial Upload

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Context

Electoral Register Format

The content of an Electoral Register is defined by legislation, but the precise format is not so defined

This means that

- Each record (row) combines details of a single Elector and their Address
- The precise fields (columns) used varies by Council
- Address data is the most affected by this, and so we have developed an algorithm to interpret the various address data formats, however it is not able to achieve 100% accuracy

Pre-Existing Canvassing Data

Many parties have gathered significant amount of canvassing data, in both previous and current election cycles - if this is the case for your party, then

- Onboarding to TTW Digital - Guide for Local Parties discusses the choices around how to get pre-existing canvassing data into the system
- This User Guide is predicated on you having selected a migration approach that uses the Electoral Register data upload

Scope of this User Guide

This guide sets out the specific steps you need to take to

- Prepare the data file
- Upload the data file

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Segmenting the Electoral Register

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Segmenting the Electoral Register

In principle, the Electoral Register can be uploaded in a single file, however this is subject to the following considerations and constraints

Ongoing Data Management

When you upload an Electoral Register Incremental (Monthly) update, you will need to manually resolve all ambiguous changes, so the greater the proportion of the Electoral Register you have uploaded, the more work that will be needed to maintain the data.

File size limit

The system supports files of up to 100,000 electors.

If you wish to load up more than this, you will need to create multiple files.

Incremental Upload

If you decide to upload a subset of the Electoral Register, you must ensure that you always upload in full each Polling District included in the subset.

Recommendation

We recommend only uploading the electoral register for wards that you intend to be active in, adding the Electoral Register incrementally as required for the Polling Districts in Wards as and when they become active.

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Data Preparation – Electoral Register

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Electoral Register fields (1) Voter

The Data File can have the following fields for each Elector

Data File Column	Definition	Required?
Elector No. Prefix	Elector Number Prefix – in practice is the Polling District (e.g. “PD1”)	YES
Elector No.	Elector Number (e.g. “136”)	YES
Elector No. Suffix	Elector Number Suffix (e.g. “0”)	YES
Full Elector No.	Full Elector Number (e.g. “PD1-136-0”) Note that this must use “-” as the separator (not e.g. “_”)	
Forename	Elector Forename (e.g. “John”)	YES
Middle Names	Elector Middle Names (e.g. “Michael”) Note that this is not displayed within the system	
Surname	Elector Surname (e.g. “Smith”)	YES
Date of Attainment	The date at which the individual has reached, or is soon to reach, the age at which they can vote Note that • This is not their date of birth, and if the Electoral Register contains that, it needs to be first converted into a date of attainment • If an invalid value is entered into this field, the upload will fail (i.e. the field has to either be blank or have a valid date)	

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Electoral Register fields (2) Address

The Data File can have the following fields for each Elector's address

Data File Column	Definition	Required?
Address1	Mapped to the following address fields within the system • House Name • House Number • Road Name You must have House Name and/or House Number	Yes
Address2		Yes
Address3		
Address4-6	Enabled, but currently other address information (e.g. town, borough etc.) is not imported	
PostCode	Post Code	Yes
UPRN	Unique Property Reference Number is the unique identifier for every addressable location across the UK, e.g. the UPRN for 10 Downing Street is 100023336956 https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Unique_Property_Reference_Number Note that this data may be used in future releases	

- All addresses will load correctly if they are in one of the supported formats – this will be the case for most records in most Electoral Registers
- Addresses with Building Names in particular need checking to ensure they are in a supported format
- Further details on supported formats are given in the following slides
- Lambeth Green Party has developed an address preparation tool that you may wish to use – please contact pedrojuk@yahoo.co.uk for more details
- It is not necessary to get every address correct in the initial upload, as Local Admin Users can correct an address as and when an issue is spotted: see User Guide <TO BE ADDED>

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House Number and Road Name (1)

If there is no House Name, then a numeric House Number and a Road Name will be correctly interpreted provided they are in either

- Address1 (House Number then Road Name)
- Address1 (House Number) and Address2 (Road Name)

This covers the vast majority of addresses and so no manual intervention will be required

Examples - Valid

Data File Field Address 1	Data File Field Address 2	Data File Field Address 3		System Field House Number	System Field House Name	System Field Road Name
8 Coleman Road	-	-	➡	8	-	Coleman Road
8	Coleman Road	-	➡	8	-	Coleman Road

Example - Invalid

Data File Field Address 1	Data File Field Address 2	Data File Field Address 3		System Field House Number	System Field House Name	System Field Road Name
8	-	Coleman Road	➡	8	8	Coleman Road

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House Number and Road Name (2)

If there is no House Name, then a mixed alphanumeric House Number and a Road Name will be correctly interpreted provided they are in either

- Address1 (House Number then Road Name)
- Address1 (House Number) and Address2 (Road Name)

Examples - Valid

Data File Field Address 1	Data File Field Address 2	Data File Field Address 3		System Field House Number	System Field House Name	System Field Road Name
16A Coleman Road	-	-	➡	16	16A	Coleman Road
16B	Coleman Road	-	➡	16	16B	Coleman Road

Example - Invalid

Data File Field Address 1	Data File Field Address 2	Data File Field Address 3		System Field House Number	System Field House Name	System Field Road Name
16C	-	Coleman Road	➡	16C	16C	Coleman Road

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Building Names (1) Overview

Building Names are more complex - if there is a Building Name (this also covers a flat address e.g. “Basement Flat”) then

- Building Name must be on its own in Address1
  - “Ontario Point”
  - “Basement Flat”
- A number or a letter can be included in Address1 provided it is after the name
  - “Flat 1”
  - “Flat B”
  - “Ontario Point Flat 1”
  - “Ontario Point 1”
  - “Ontario Point Flat B”
  - “Ontario Point B”
  - “[100-102]”
- House Number and Road Name must follow in either
  - Address2 (House Number then Road Name)
  - Address2 (House Number) and Address3 (Road Name)
- If there is no House Number, then Road Name must follow in Address2
  - House Number will be recorded as “0” (zero)

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Building Names (2) Examples (1) Valid

Data File Field Address 1	Data File Field Address 2	Data File Field Address 3	System Field House Number	System Field House Name	System Field Road Name
16A Coleman Road	-	-	16	16A	Coleman Road
16B	Coleman Road	-	16	16B	Coleman Road
South House 14	21 Coleman Road	-	21	South House 14	Coleman Road
South House	21 Coleman Road	-	21	South House	Coleman Road
South House	21	Coleman Road	21	South House	Coleman Road
B	16 Coleman Road	-	16	B	Coleman Road
Ontario Point 55	Coleman Road	-	0	Ontario Point 55	Coleman Road
Flat 3, 30 Dalrymple Road	-	-	30	Flat 3	Dalrymple Road
James Cottage	52a Coleman Road		52	James Cottage 52a	Coleman Road
James Cottage 52a	52 Coleman Road		52	James Cottage 52a	Coleman Road

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Building Names (3) Examples (2) Invalid

Data File Field Address 1	Data File Field Address 2	Data File Field Address 3		System Field House Number	System Field House Name	System Field Road Name
14 South House	Coleman Road	-	→	14	-	South House
56 Flat 1	Coleman Road	-	→	56	-	Flat 1
1ST & 2ND	9 Coleman Road	-	→	-	1ST & 2ND	9 Coleman Road
3 Connell Court, Lindal Road	-	-	→	3	-	Connell Court

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Building Names (4) Recommended

To make Rounds set up easy, the recommended address format is as follows

Data File Field Address 1	Data File Field Address 2	Data File Field Address 3		System Field House Number	System Field House Name	System Field Road Name
<BUILDING> xxx	<ROAD NAME>		➡	0	<BUILDING> xxx	<STREET NAME>
<BUILDING> xxx	y <ROAD NAME>		➡	y	<BUILDING> xxx	<STREET NAME>

- "xxx" is the flat number using as many preceding zeroes as necessary
  - If a block has 150 addresses, then it should be 001 (first address) ➡️ 010 ➡️ 100 ➡️ 150 (final address)
- "y" is the (optional) street number of the building and if blank, is treated as 0

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Data Preparation – Pre-Existing Data

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Pre-Existing Data fields (1)

You can upload data for up to 10 previous or future elections relating to electors in the current Electoral Register

- Note that each Election must be set up in the system as per "Elections" in User Guide: C1 Party Management

For every election, you can upload the following

CSV Column	Definition	Valid Values
<ELECTION NAME> Green Voting Intention	Likelihood of voting Green	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, BLANK
<ELECTION NAME> Party	Usual party	See following slide

For a historic election, you can additionally upload

CSV Column	Definition	Valid Values
<ELECTION NAME> Voted	Whether the elector voted in that election	Any value = "Y" BLANK = "N"

For a future election, you can additionally upload

CSV Column	Definition	Valid Values
<ELECTION NAME> Postal Voter	If the elector has a postal vote	Any value = "Y" BLANK = "N"

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Pre-Existing Data fields (2)

You can upload data for the following Usual Parties

- Greens
- Labour
- Conservatives
- Liberal Democrats
- Reform (and its predecessors)
- Plaid Cymru
- Residents Association
- Independent
- Others

Ensure you use a consistent coding method, e.g.

- “G” means “Green Party”
- “L” means “Labour”
- “LD” means “LibDems”
- “Ind” means “Independent”

etc.

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Preparing the Data File

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File format (1)

Use one of the templates

- Data File Template - Electoral Register Only
- Data File Template - Electoral Register plus Data

or ensure that your data file use these field (column) names (see slides 4, 5 and11)

Confirm the format

- Ensure that all required fields (columns) have the correct field name (column header) in Row 1
- Delete any optional fields (columns) for which you do not have data
- Ensure that your file has field names (column headers) that are unique

Check the data fields

- Ensure that all required fields (columns) are populated
- Ensure that optional fields (columns) are populated where data exists
- Ensure that fields (columns) have valid data
  - Some electors may have no address (e.g. for security reasons) – ensure these electors have been deleted
  - Specifically check Building Names (see slides 8 and 9)

Example Data Files (populated with test data)

- Electoral Register Only
- Electoral Register plus Data for one historic Election and one future Election

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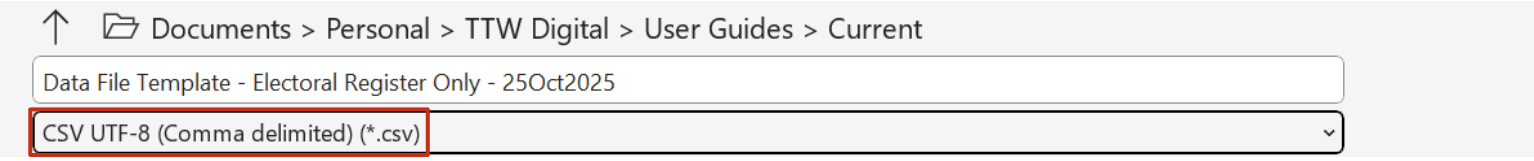
File format (2)

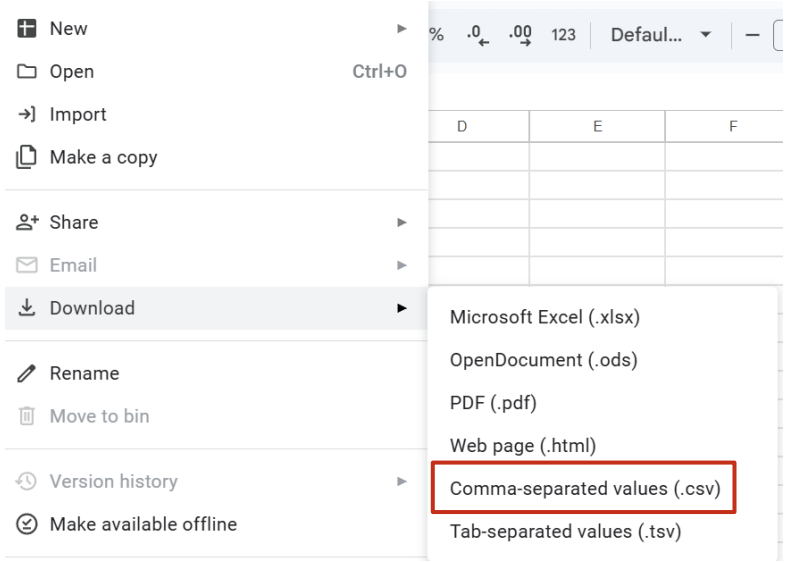
The upload file needs to be saved in a CSV UTF-8 (Comma-Separated Values) format

Excel files



- Note that there are other CSV variants available in Excel – use of those can cause the upload to fail

Google Sheets



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Upload

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Submit to TTW Support for Upload

First parties to onboard, we will directly support you with the set up and load into our Sandbox environment

- Check that the data uploads correctly
- Check you can see the uploaded data in the Canvassing Screens as expected
- Ask us any questions about the data load and raise any issues

Parties onboarding later will be able to check this directly in the Sandbox environment

- This User Guide will be updated at that point to step through the data upload process

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